Swords of the Serpentine

Name

True Name? ☐
Check if True Name is known

Profession

Adjectives

What is Best in Life?

○ _____
○ _____
○ _____

Character Portrait

INVESTIGATIVE ABILITIES

Social

Charm	○○○○○
Command	○○○○○
Intimidation	○○○○○
Liar's Tell	○○○○○
Nobility	○○○○○
Servility	○○○○○
Taunt	○○○○○
Trustworthy	○○○○○

Sentinel

Felonious Intent	○○○○○
Laws & Traditions	○○○○○
Spirit Sight	○○○○○
Vigilance	○○○○○

Sorcerer

Corruption	○○○○○
Forgotten Lore	○○○○○
Leechcraft	○○○○○
Prophecy	○○○○○

Thief

City's Secrets	○○○○○
Ridiculous Luck	○○○○○
Scurrilous Rumors	○○○○○
Skulduggery	○○○○○

Warrior

Know Monstrosities	○○○○○
Spot Frailty (Health / Morale)	○○○○○
Tactics of Death	○○○○○
Wilderness Mastery	○○○○○

GENERAL ABILITIES

Athletics	☐	○○○○○○○ **○** ○○○○○○○	Dodge
Bind Wounds	☐	○○○○○○○ **○** ○○○○○○○	Plenty of Leeches
Burglary	☐	○○○○○○○ **○** ○○○○○○○	Fast Hands
Preparedness	☐	○○○○○○○ **○** ○○○○○○○	Flashback
Stealth	☐	○○○○○○○ **○** ○○○○○○○	Where'd She Go?
Sorcery	☐	○○○○○○○ **○** ○○○○○○○	Blast
Sway	☐	○○○○○○○ **○** ○○○○○○○	Play to the Crowd
Warfare	☐	○○○○○○○ **○** ○○○○○○○	Cleave

ALLEGIANCES

_____	○○○○○
_____	○○○○○
_____	○○○○○
_____	○○○○○
_____	○○○○○

Wealth _____

Lifestyle _____ ○○

Health (-12) (-11) (-10) (-9) (-8) (-7) (-6) (-5) (-4) (-3) (-2) (-1) (0) (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) (6) (7) (8) (9) (10) (11) (12) (13) (14) (15)

Morale (-12) (-11) (-10) (-9) (-8) (-7) (-6) (-5) (-4) (-3) (-2) (-1) (0) (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) (6) (7) (8) (9) (10) (11) (12) (13) (14) (15)

Threshold	Armor
Threshold	Grit

GEAR

5+ items of character-defining gear grants 1 point of Grit

SORCEROUS SPHERES

Affects: Health Morale

Character Creation — Step by Step

Fill in the official character sheet as you go. Takes ~10 minutes. You can leave points unspent and assign during play.

1 Profession — pick one (or mix). This is a label, not a cage.
Sentinel (investigator, inquisitor) · **Sorcerer** (magic user) · **Thief** (rogue, spy) · **Warrior** (fighter, barbarian) · or mix freely.
Write it in the Profession field.

2 Adjectives — 3–5 words describing your personality. Quick reference for how you act under pressure.
Write in the Adjectives field.

3 Drives — "What is Best in Life?" Answer three things. These are your motivations. When a Drive is relevant, **+1 to any roll**.
Write in the three "What is Best in Life?" lines.

4 Investigative Abilities — fill bubbles on the sheet.
Points by player count:

Players	Ability points
3	12
4	11
5+	10

Spend on any Investigative ability from any profession. You also get 3 additional points for Allegiances (Step 5).
Bonus: If ALL your profession picks (not Social, not Allegiances) come from one profession, **+1 free point**.
See the Ability Lookup sheet for what each ability does.

5 Allegiances — using your 3 additional Allegiance points, assign:
2 points to Allies (one faction or split between two) — people who help you
1 point to an Enemy — a faction that opposes you
Write faction names + fill bubbles in the Allegiances section.

Ancient Nobility	Proud, crumbling old families
Church of Denari	Commerce goddess, moneylenders, inquisitors
City Watch	Underfunded law enforcement
Commoners	Working people — many, organized, resentful
Mercanti	New-money merchant guilds
Mercenaries	Professional soldiers, loyal while paid
Monstrosities	Non-humans living under/in the city
Outlanders	Foreigners, barbarians, travelers
Sorcerous Cabals	Illegal magic users, secretive
Thieves' Guilds	Smugglers, criminals, shadow power
Triskadane	13 anonymous rulers + secret police

> Allegiances are roleplay flavor AND mechanical — use Ally ranks to call in favors, get information, or summon help.

6 General Abilities — split **30 points** among these. Fill bubbles on the sheet.

Ability	What it does	Talent at 8+
Athletics	Run, jump, climb, swim	Dodge attacks
Bind Wounds	Heal Health (1 pt → 2 HP to others)	Heal self equally
Burglary	Pick locks, steal, sleight of hand	Pickpocket as free action
Preparedness	Roll to have what you need	Flashback — retroactively planned for this
Stealth	Move unseen	Vanish and reappear anywhere
Sorcery	Magic attacks (needs Corruption 1+)	Blast — hit multiple foes
Sway	Fear/persuade → damages Morale	Play to the Crowd — hit multiple foes' Morale
Warfare	Weapon attacks → damages Health	Cleave — hit multiple foes

Max rule: no ability can exceed 2× your next-highest ability.

> Have at least one combat ability (Warfare, Sway, or Sorcery) at 5+. At 8+ you get a Talent — worth it.

7 Health & Morale — split **18 points** between them (min 3 each). Circle your rank on the track.
10+ in either → Threshold becomes 4 (instead of 3).
Write your Threshold in the box.
With 18 points, you can reach 10+ in one stat (e.g. 10/8) but not both.

8 Gear — write 5+ items that define who you are. One is your weapon (sets Damage Modifier: small +0, medium +1, large +2). One can be armor (leather = Armor 1, chain = Armor 2).
5+ items of gear → Grit 1. Write Grit 1 in the Grit box.

9 Sorcery — only if you have Corruption 1+. Check whether your Sorcery attacks Health or Morale (permanent choice). Pick 1 Sphere per Corruption rank. Write Spheres on the sheet. Pick your source (Serpentine writings or Demon/Spirit).
See the Sorcery Cheat Sheet for details.

10 Name — anything you like. Fantasy Italian-ish fits the setting, but not required. Skip True Name (not relevant for one-shot). Ignore Wealth/Lifestyle fields.

> **Stuck?** Leave points unspent and assign during play when you realize you need something. You can also redistribute freely after your first session.